Kosiso Madu

Department of Economics
Lerner College of Business and Economics
University of Delaware
416C Purnell Hall, Newark, DE 19716
kemadu@udel.edu | linkedin.com/in/kosiso-madu

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University of Delaware Expected 2027

Dissertation: "Essays in Labor Market Constraints"

M.S. in Mathematics, Illinois State University 2021

M.S. in Economics, Illinois State University 2021

B.Sc. in Economics, University of Nigeria, Nsukka 2016

Fields

Primary: Labor Economics

Secondary: Economics of Gender, Economics of AI

Research

Working Papers

Who Earns? Universal Pre-K and the Division of Labor Within Households *Job Market Paper*

Using a stacked triple-difference design exploiting variation in UPK adoption and child age eligibility, I study how married couples reorganize market work and earnings when their youngest child becomes eligible for UPK. UPK raises wives' labor force participation by 6.6 percentage points, while husbands' participation is unchanged. Wives' share of couple earnings rises by 3.9 percentage points, and traditional specialization, in which the husband supplies the larger share of market hours, falls by 4.0 percentage points. The results show that the maternal labor-supply response to childcare access is accompanied by a shift in the distribution of market work and earnings within the household.

Career Outcomes Under Relaxed Constraints: Does the STEM-OPT Extension Affect Employment and Career Paths of Foreign-Born Doctoral Students?

This paper asks whether relaxing employment restrictions changes where highly skilled immigrants work, or only whether they work. Using restricted-access microdata from the Survey of Earned Doctorates, I study the 2008 extension of Optional Practical Training for STEM graduates. The extension raised the probability of holding a definite employment commitment at graduation by 2.2 percentage points. The gain, however, accrued to academic rather than industry positions.

Work in Progress

Asymmetric Observability and Steering in Commercial AI *(with Afam Madu)*

We develop a model of commercial AI in which an AI system serves a user seeking accurate output and a developer with incentives to steer the output toward more profitable actions. We examine how differences in the user's and

developer's ability to observe the system's actions shape AI steering and alignment.

Leveling Up or Down? Pay Transparency and the Gender Wage Gap

This project examines the effect of state pay-transparency laws on wages and the gender wage gap using CPS ORG data and a stacked difference-in-differences design across nine staggered adoptions.

Technical Skills

Stata, Python, LaTeX

Grants, Honors, and Awards

Economics Graduate Teaching Excellence Award, University of Delaware 2025

Summer Research Stipend, Department of Economics, University of Delaware 2024

Teaching Experience

University of Delaware

Economic Issues and Policies, *Instructor* Fall 2026

Banking and Monetary Policy, *Instructor* Winter 2024, Winter 2025, Summer 2025, Winter 2026, Spring 2026

Data Analysis for Business and Economics, *Co-Instructor* Fall 2024

Introduction to Microeconomics, *Teaching Assistant* Fall 2023–Spring 2024

Banking and Monetary Policy, *Teaching Assistant* Spring 2022–Spring 2023

Introduction to Econometrics, *Teaching Assistant* Fall 2021

Other Experience

Research Assistant for Professors Dimitrios Nikolaou and Oguzhan Dincer, Illinois State University 2018–2020

Presentations

Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting 2025

EconNect Africa Symposium 2025

Service Activities

Founder, WE-Mentorship Club, Nigeria 2021–present

Additional Activities and Training

Hennovate the State Hackathon, Best Creative Award (Team Labor) 2026

Machine Learning and Big Data Workshop, Pittsburgh Supercomputing Center (ACCESS) 2026

Innovative Teaching Strategies Certificate, University of Delaware 2025

Graduate Certificate in Women and Gender Studies, Illinois State University 2021

References

Professor Adrienne Lucas
Department of Economics
University of Delaware
(302) 831-1901
alucas@udel.edu

Professor Olga Gorbachev
Department of Economics
University of Delaware
(302) 831-2563
olgag@udel.edu

Professor Barton Willage
Department of Economics
University of Delaware
(812) 599-1079
willage@udel.edu